

nn

threnne

A romance studio. Tools, research, and a reciprocal beta exchange — built for romance writers, by people inside the genre.

STUDIO

THRENNE

RESEARCH

ROMANCE SIGNAL

TOOL

A03 WORKS

three brands. one studio.

Threnne is the parent — the romance studio. Romance Signal is the research wing. AO3 Works is the tool. They share a typographic system and a palette; each carries its own accent color so they read as siblings, not duplicates.

PARENT • STUDIO

nn

threnne

Houses the Beta Exchange as the flagship service. Tools, services, and resources for romance writers and the industry around them.

SUB • RESEARCH

s.

romance signal

The research wing. Working in public on what makes a romance succeed — datasets, dispatches, and methods published as they're figured out.

SUB • TOOL

w3

ao3 works

Browser-based editor for formatting works, social posts, letters and more for AO3. Live previews. No code required.

ARCHITECTURE • SUBDOMAINS UNDER THE PARENT

● threnne.com

● signal.threnne.com

● works.threnne.com

one ground per mode, three accents.

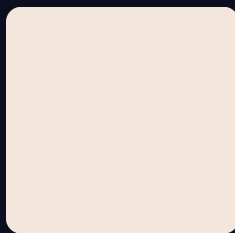
The system has two grounds (ink, near-white) and three accents (pink, acid, teal). Acid darkens dramatically in light mode — it becomes deep teal — because true acid loses contrast on near-white. Pink and teal hold across both modes with minor adjustments.

DARK MODE



INK
#0C0F1F

Primary ground. Deep navy-black with a blue undertone.



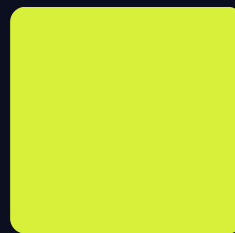
CREAM
#F3E6DC

Primary text on dark. Warm, never clinical white.



PINK
#D1396A

Threnne accent. Wine pink — grown-up, never candy.



ACID
#D8F03A

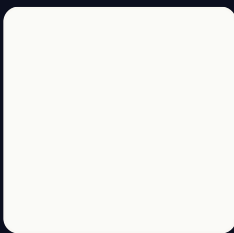
Romance Signal accent. Sharp, research-coded.



TEAL
#5DAD9F

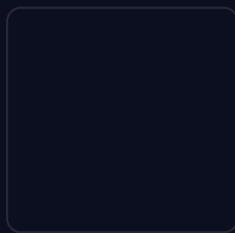
AO3 Works accent. Cool, utility-coded.

● LIGHT MODE



NEAR-WHITE
#FAFAF7

Primary ground. Modern editorial, not cream.



INK
#0C0F1F

Primary text on light. Same as dark-mode ground.



PINK
#D1396A

Threnne accent. Holds across both modes.



DEEP TEAL
#134E4A

Signal light variant. Acid doesn't survive on white.



TEAL
#2E6B5F

Works light variant. Deeper than dark mode for contrast.

two-character marks. one type family.

Every brand mark is two characters in Hanken Grotesk Medium. Threnne's nn is drawn from the wordmark. Signal's s. reads like a journal abbreviation. Works' w3 references the platform (AO3) without lifting its identity.

01 · THRENNE

nn

The double-n is the only repeated letter in "threnne."
Two of the same letter together is a quiet metaphor for what the studio is about.

02 · ROMANCE SIGNAL

s.

Single letter plus period.
Reads like a research journal abbreviation (Nat., Sci.) — confident, declarative, faintly academic.

03 · AO3 WORKS

w3

The w is for Works. The 3 quietly references AO3 — the platform the tool serves — without lifting AO3's actual identity.

TYPOGRAPHY

DISPLAY + UI

HANKEN GROTESK

Wordmarks, marks, headlines, body. Weights 400-500 primarily; 300 for editorial display. Tight letter-spacing on display.

MONOSPACE + LABELS

JETBRAINS MONO

Eyebrows, labels, code, data values. Weight 400-500. Letter-spaced 0.15-0.22em uppercase.

threnne · romance signal · ao3
works

A romance studio est. 2026 · open
research published live · 8,420 works
formatted

color as wayfinding, not decoration.

Each surface has a primary color (its own accent), with the other two as secondary and tertiary signals. The whole palette appears everywhere — different proportions per surface. On charts, the lead data point gets the primary color; supporting data takes secondary and tertiary.

Rule 01

primary first.

Each brand surface leads with its own accent — pink for Threnne, acid for Signal, teal for Works. The primary appears at three high-visibility moments: nav mark, primary CTA, and one signature highlight. No more.

Rule 02

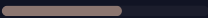
secondaries for wayfinding.

The other two accents appear once or twice per surface as cross-brand wayfinding — a link to the sibling, a small meta dot. The system should feel like one family, not three isolated brands.

Rule 03

charts encode hierarchy.

Primary data takes the surface's primary color. Secondary data takes the secondary accent (referencing one sibling). Tertiary takes the third. Everything below the top three goes to cream-faint and recedes.

Strong opening		78%
Reciprocated		71%
Earned crisis		64%
Distinct voice		58%

Rule 04

restraint is the brand.

Cream-on-ink (or ink-on-near-white) does ~85% of the visual work on every surface. The accents are punctuation. If a page has more than 5-6 accent moments, it is over-decorated. Subtract before you add.

don'ts

- ✗ Do not use pink as a decorative accent across every section — it earns its place at specific moments.
- ✗ Do not use acid #D8F03A on near-white. It loses contrast. Use Deep Teal #134E4A.
- ✗ Do not use Title Case in marks or wordmarks. Threnne is lowercase always.
- ✗ Do not pair marks with other AO3 branding in ways that imply official affiliation.
- ✗ Do not tighten lowercase wordmarks past -0.05em letter-spacing — letters merge into noise.
- ✗ Do not use the marks at less than 16px equivalent — the two characters become unreadable.